THE ANSWER IS NO

# They asked for a raise. You can't give it.

What you say next decides if they still trust you in March.

# Saying no to a raise

| SOUNDS LIKE THIS | NOT THIS |
| --- | --- |
| “The answer is no for this cycle. Here is why.” | “Let me see what I can do.” |
| “This is what would change the answer.” | “Maybe next year.” |
| “Let’s look at it again in March.” | “It’s out of my hands.” |

# A clear no is kinder than a slow maybe.

They can plan around no. They can’t plan around maybe.